

CleanTech Open 2025: Scorer & Evaluation Manual

Step-by-step instructions for evaluating startup applications, utilizing the AI Due Diligence Copilot, and navigating founder deliverables with auto-citation jumping.

Target: Expert Judges, Mentors & Investors

Portal URL: `/index.html`

Evaluation Framework: 10 Categories (282 Criteria)

1 Getting Started & Logging In

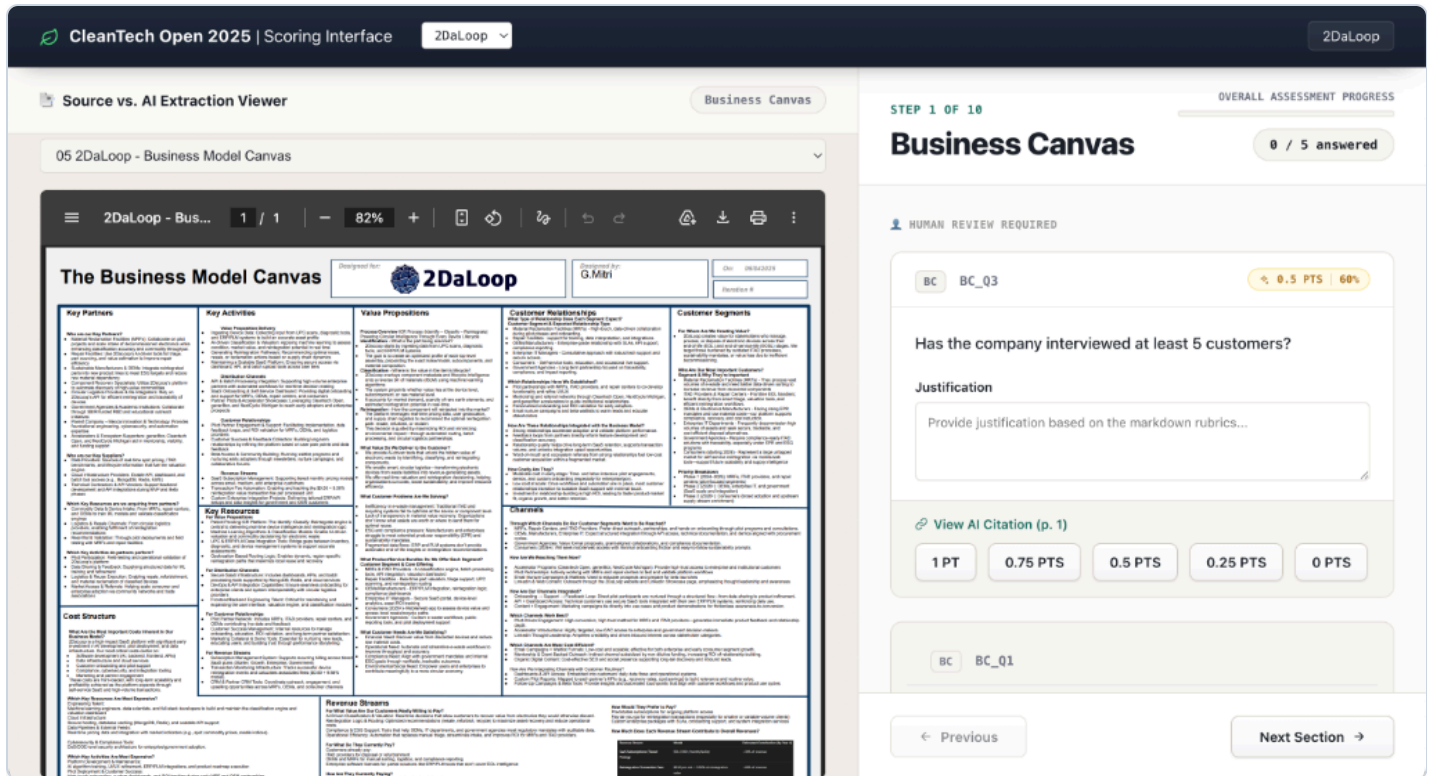
As a CleanTech Open judge, you have been assigned specific cleantech startups to evaluate. Your evaluations determine accelerator cohort admissions, awards, and investment readiness.

1. Navigate to the scoring portal at `/index.html`.
2. In the **Judge Authentication** modal, enter:
 - **Scorer ID:** Your assigned username (e.g., `judge_smith` or `J-001`).
 - **Passcode:** Your individual access passcode provided by the administrator.
3. Click **Sign In**.
4. In the top dark navigation bar, click the **Company Dropdown** to view the startups assigned to you. Select the startup you wish to evaluate to load its application workspace.

Cloud Auto-Save: Every score selection and justification note is **automatically saved to the Supabase database** the moment you click a score or pause typing. You can safely reload the page or return on another device without losing work.

2 The Split-Screen Evaluation Workspace

The CleanTech Open scoring interface features a high-velocity **Side-by-Side Split Workspace** designed to eliminate window tab flipping. The left panel is dedicated to original founder deliverables, while the right panel displays your active scoring rubric and AI guidance.



Workspace Layout Overview

LEFT PANEL: Source vs. AI Extraction Viewer

- **Deliverable Selector Dropdown:** Switch between any uploaded PDF for the active evaluation module (e.g., *05 2DaLoop - Business Model Canvas*).
- **Module Tag:** Displays current category context (e.g. Business Canvas).
- **Integrated PDF Viewer:** Complete in-browser document reader with zoom (+/-), page jump, rotation, pan, print, and local download.
- **Auto-Jumping Canvas:** Automatically snaps to the exact page when an AI citation is clicked on the right!

RIGHT PANEL: Step-by-Step Scoring & Rubric

- **Module Step Indicator:** Shows current section (e.g., STEP 1 OF 10) and live progress (e.g., 0 / 5 answered).
- **Overall Assessment Progress Bar:** Visual progress tracking completion across all 282 criteria.
- **Evaluation Cards:** Scrollable criteria cards containing rubric text, AI suggestion pills, and point selectors.
- **Section Footer:** ← Previous and Next Section → buttons to transition between modules.

3 The AI Copilot & The Mandatory Human Review Rule



CRITICAL PROTOCOL: HUMAN REVIEW IS MANDATORY REGARDLESS OF AI CONFIDENCE

Never rubber-stamp high-confidence AI suggestions. An AI confidence rating of 90%, 95%, or 100% does **NOT** mean the startup's claim is commercially viable, technically sound, or factually true in the real world.

- **What AI Confidence Actually Measures:** The AI confidence score solely reflects *how clearly an explicit textual statement was found* in the founder's uploaded text. If a founder writes "Our technology has zero competitors and 100% customer retention", the AI will extract a high-confidence match (1.0 PT | 95% Conf).
- **What the AI Cannot Do:** The AI cannot verify whether the founder's claim is realistic, whether lab data supports it, whether customer interviews were genuine, or whether the competitive analysis is superficial.
- **Your Role as an Expert Judge:** You **must click the citation link**, review the cited passage in the PDF viewer on the left, inspect the surrounding context, and determine whether the startup genuinely satisfied the standard. **You have full authority to override the AI whenever founder evidence lacks depth or credibility.**

Anatomy of an Interactive Evaluation Card

Each evaluation card in the right panel is structured for rapid diligence and transparent accountability:

EVALUATION CARD BREAKDOWN

MODULE: BUSINESS CANVAS (BC)

HUMAN REVIEW REQUIRED

0.5 PTS | 60% Conf

BC BC_Q3

Has the company interviewed at least 5 customers?

Justification

View Examples

Provide justification based on the markdown rubrics...

View AI Citation (p. 1)

05_2DaLoop_Business_Model_Canvas.pdf

"Interviews we've completed before (NSF I-Corps) indicates that enterprise IT managers require standardized SLA guarantees..."

Switched viewer to Page 1. Use **Cmd+F** / **Ctrl+F** in the viewer to locate exact text.

1 PT

0.75 PTS

0.5 PTS

0.25 PTS

0 PTS

4 The 10 Evaluation Categories

Judges evaluate startups across 10 standardized modules. Use the *Next Section* → and ← *Previous* buttons at the bottom of the right panel to move sequentially through each section:

Code	Module Title	Questions	Primary Deliverable(s) Reviewed in Left Panel
BC	Business Canvas	5 Questions (BC_Q1–Q5)	Business Model Canvas (EBD1) & Customer Discovery capture
ES	Environmental & Social	10 Questions (ES_Q1–Q10)	Impact Statement (EBD2) & Sustainability module questions
F	Financials	29 Questions (F_Q1–Q29)	3-Year Financial Projections (EBD5) & unit economics model
IP	Investor Pitch	58 Questions (IP_Q1–Q58)	Investor Pitch Deck (EBD8) & full diligence slide presentation
IS	Executive Summary	34 Questions (IS_Q1–Q34)	1-Page Executive Summary (EBD6) & core company narrative
L	Legal & Governance	53 Questions (L_Q1–Q53)	IP filings, corporate formation, governance & legal review
M	Market & Customers	12 Questions (M_Q1–Q12)	Customer Segmentation & Competitive Matrix (EBD3)
PMF	Product Market Fit	34 Questions (PMF_Q1–Q34)	Customer interviews, discovery log & target customer segments
T	Team Targets	31 Questions (T_Q1–Q31)	Team hiring plans, targets & milestones
TP	Tech / Product	16 Questions (TP_Q1–Q16)	Technology Validation (EBD4) & Technical testimonials
TOTAL	10 Evaluation Categories	282 Questions Total	Standardized CleanTech Open Diligence Rubric

5 Step-by-Step Diligence Checklist

Follow this standardized 5-step workflow for every startup assigned to you:

Step	Action	Description & Best Practice
Step 1	Executive Summary	Start in the Executive Summary (IS) category to read the founder's 1-page overview and understand the core thesis.
Step 2	Category Progression	Progress systematically through the 10 categories using the bottom navigation buttons. Watch the overall progress bar fill.
Step 3	Inspect Citations	On each question, click " View AI Citation " to verify the founder's claim against the embedded PDF deliverable on the left.
Step 4	Record Score & Notes	Select your point verdict. If the question requires justification or if you disagree with the AI, type your brief explanation.
Step 5	Final Verification	Click " Confirm & Submit " when prompted to finalize and flush all scores to the database.

6 Scorer FAQs & Pro-Tips

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What if the AI Citation says "No direct evidence exists"?

A: This means the startup's submitted deliverables did not address this specific criterion. If you independently search the document and cannot locate evidence, award **0 PTS**.

Q: Can I view the official rubric scoring guidelines?

A: Yes! On questions with official rubric guidelines (e.g. Business Canvas), click the " **View Examples**" link in the question card to view rubric thresholds and real-world grading examples calibrated directly to the **0 – 1 point scale** (0, 0.25, 0.5, 0.75, 1.0 PTS).

Q: How do I zoom or download a startup PDF?

A: The live PDF viewer on the left includes full browser controls in the top toolbar: zoom in/out (+/-), page jump, and a direct download icon to inspect the file in your preferred PDF reader.

Q: What if I notice a document misclassification?

A: The deliverable dropdown above the PDF viewer allows you to switch between all documents attached to that category. If you need to view a deliverable from another category, navigate to that category section.

Q: What happens if I close my browser before clicking Submit?

A: All scores and justifications are continuously saved to the Supabase database in real time. When you reopen the portal, all your answers will automatically reload from the database.